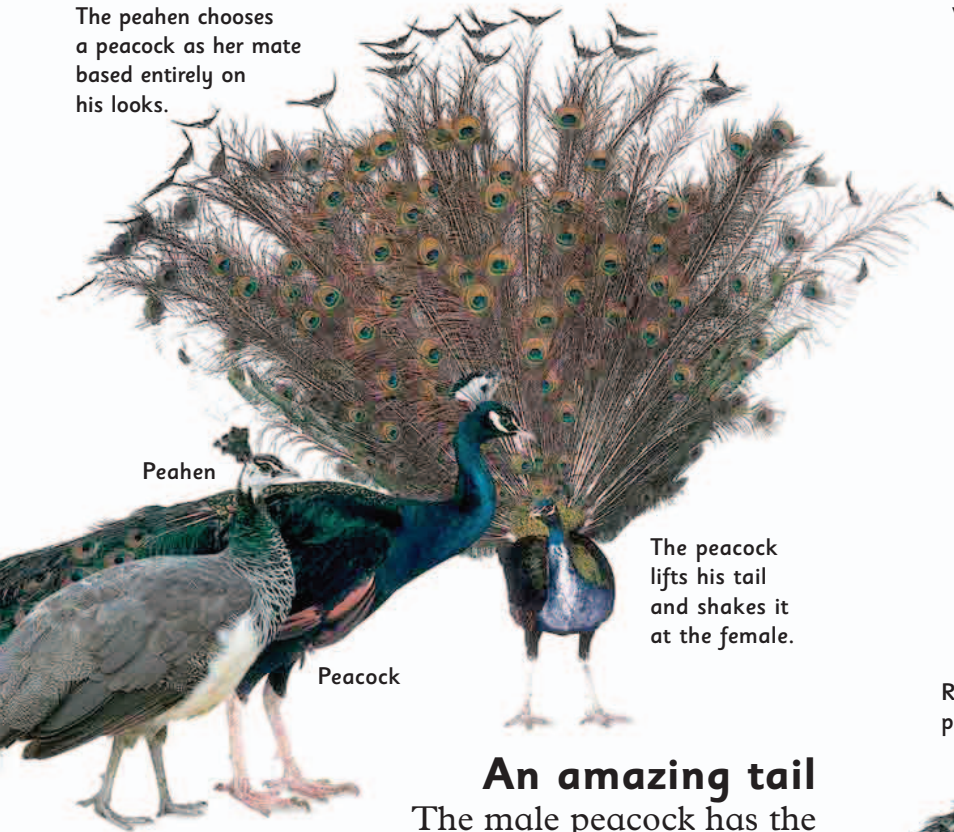


The peahen chooses a peacock as her mate based entirely on his looks.



Peahen

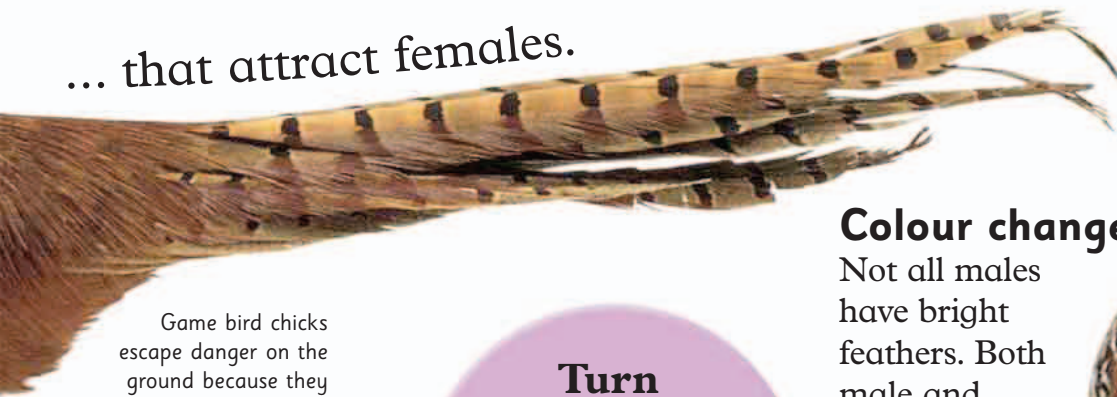
Peacock

The peacock lifts his tail and shakes it at the female.

An amazing tail

The male peacock has the most spectacular tail in the animal world. When he wants to attract attention, he raises it high.

... that attract females.



Game bird chicks escape danger on the ground because they are able to run and fly soon after hatching.



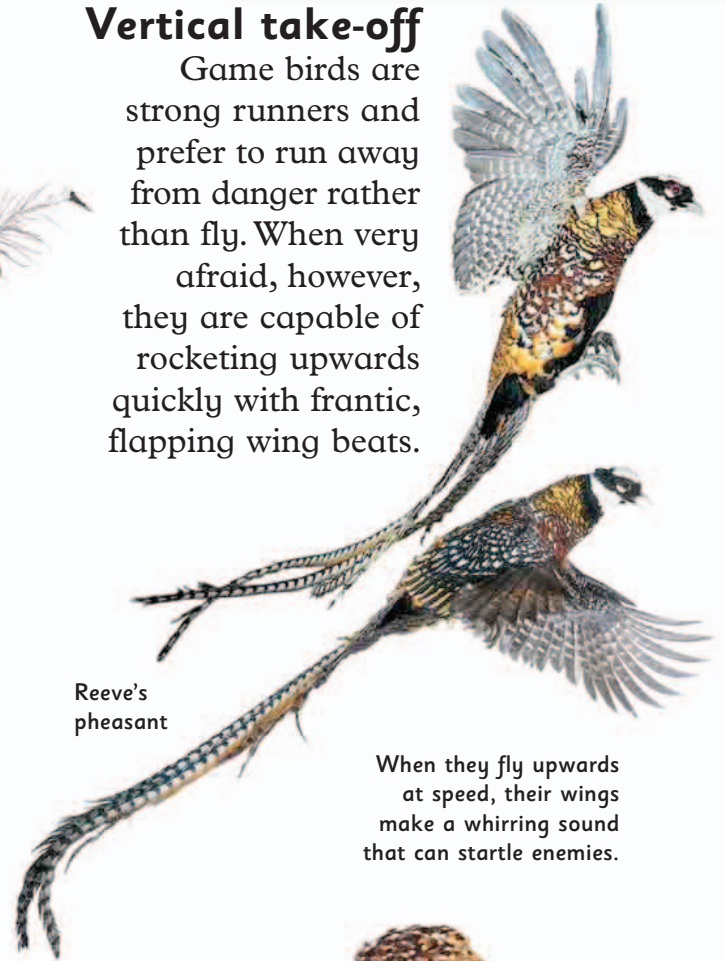
Pheasant chicks

Turn and learn

Courtship displays between birds:
pp. 52-53

Vertical take-off

Game birds are strong runners and prefer to run away from danger rather than fly. When very afraid, however, they are capable of rocketing upwards quickly with frantic, flapping wing beats.



Reeve's pheasant

When they fly upwards at speed, their wings make a whirring sound that can startle enemies.

Colour change

Not all males have bright feathers. Both male and female willow ptarmigans change their colours throughout the seasons so they are always camouflaged.



This male ptarmigan is in its summer plumage.